

Classroom Observation: The Essentials

Seven Principles for Good Practice in Undergraduate Education.

by

A.W. Chickering, Z. F. Gamson

1. Encourages contacts between students and faculty
2. Develops reciprocity and cooperation among students
3. Uses active learning techniques
4. Gives prompt feedback
5. Emphasizes time on task
6. Communicates high expectations
7. Respects diverse talents and ways of learning

American Association for Higher Education, Volume 39; Number 7, 1987

During the classroom observation the observer will be looking at the following areas. These are intended to provide the faculty member with a clearer understanding of the criteria for this aspect of the evaluation.

Instructional Facilities - Are there any aspects of the classroom that detract from the learning environment (seating, lighting, external noise, etc.)?

Overall Classroom Environment - Does the instructor greet students warmly? Are students recognized by name? Do students appear comfortable in the class? Do they sit near the instructor? How are late arriving students managed?

Instructional Lesson Planning - Does the instructor help establish the relevancy of the lesson in terms of how it fits into the course? Are objectives used to identify the intent of the day's activities? Does the lesson include a review of previous course materials?

Classroom Management - Does the instructor appear prepared and organized? How does the student/teacher relationship appear? Do students appear comfortable asking questions? How are late arriving students handled? How are disruptive students handled?

Class Session - Are the class session objectives clearly identified? What types of instructional strategies are used? Does the lesson seem logically sequenced? Does the instructor refer to objectives periodically during the lesson? How does the instructor attempt to involve students in the class? Are students actively involved in the class session? How does the instructor respond to correct and incorrect student responses? Does the instructor demonstrate a positive role model for the students? Are multiple learning styles addressed during this session? What type(s) of instructional media are used during the class session? Does the instructor refer to outside references such as text, web sites, or articles?

Summary - What strategies seem to be most effective and what strategies were least effective? What techniques might have been included in this session to improve it?

Instructor: Buddhi RaiCourse: PHY 112Classroom: 8570# of Students 33Date: 4/1/13**Facilities**

Is the physical environment conducive to learning?

This is a really large room for such a small class - but Buddhi did a good job of projecting his voice and moving up and down the stairs to keep every one engaged

Overall Classroom Environment

Does the instructor greet students? What level of interaction between the instructor and students takes place prior to class beginning? Are students called upon by name?

Yes - he spoke with individuals as they entered

Where do students seem to be seated? Do they sit near the instructor?

This large lecture hall has a projection screen in the center of the blackboard and most students opted to sit where they had the most direct line of sight to the screen and the instructor.

Planning

Does the instructor help establish the relevancy of the lesson in terms of how it fits into the course?

Yes - Dr. Rai had the objectives written on the board and did a review of the material they had received last session.

Are objectives used to identify the intent of the day's activities?

On the board and students attention were called to them often throughout the class.

Does the lesson include a review of previous course materials?

Yes - he started with a review as well as asking the students to complete problems from the last chapter.

Classroom Management

Does the instructor appear prepared and organized?

Absolutely! He moved seamlessly from board to power point to quiet working on problems that focused the students on the material being taught.

How does the student/teacher relationship appear?

respectful and cordial. Two weeks after the class session a student stopped me in the hall to tell me how much he liked Dr. Rai as an instructor and how much he had learned from him.

Do students appear comfortable asking questions?

Yes- the interjected questions at appropriate times throughout the lecture.

Are there any distractions and if so, how are disruptive students handled?

none-

How are late-arriving students handled?

Late students took their seats quickly and quietly - most sat in the back as not to disturb others.

Class Session

Are the class session objectives clearly identified?

Yes - on the black board, power point outline and verbally

What types of instructional strategies are used?

Yes - demonstrations and hands on manipulatives were used as well as lecture. Students also had time to solve problems then check the solutions together.

Does the lesson seem logically sequenced?

Yes. Buddhi started with the end of chapter 22 and began chapter 23.

Does the instructor refer to objectives periodically during the lesson?

yes - throughout

How does the instructor attempt to involve students in the class? Are students actively involved in the class session?

He asked questions throughout and had them use a laser and fiber optics.

How does the instructor respond to correct and incorrect student responses?

He was very positive to responses.

Does the instructor demonstrate a positive role model for the students?

Absolutely - he is very energetic, well prepared and knowledgeable,

Are multiple learning styles addressed during this session?

Yes - lecture, manipulations, and visual

What type(s) of instructional media are used during the class session?

blackboard, visualizer, power point

Does the instructor refer to outside references such as text, web sites, or articles?

yes - textbook references with page numbers

Summary:

What are the greatest strengths demonstrated during today's class session?

Dr. Rai is very knowledgeable, open to student questions, and kept the class session moving along. I love coming to a class where I actually learn something!

What might be done to improve this class session?

nothing- continue doing what you are doing!

Rating:

☐ Unprofessional Performance
☐ Professional Level

☐ Improvement Required
☒ Exemplary Performance

Observation Conducted by:

Deborah Coates

4/30/13
Date

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Summary - What strategies seem to be most effective and what strategies were least effective? What techniques might have been included in this session to improve it?

Instructor: Buddhi RaiCourse: PHY 110Classroom: 7120# of Students 32Date: 10/31/12**Facilities**

Is the physical environment conducive to learning?

yes - lots of space and well lit.**Overall Classroom Environment**

Does the instructor greet students? What level of interaction between the instructor and students takes place prior to class beginning? Are students called upon by name?

Students were greeted with smiles and words of welcome.

Where do students seem to be seated? Do they sit near the instructor?

The students were spaced in the center of the room near the instructor.**Planning**

Does the instructor help establish the relevancy of the lesson in terms of how it fits into the course?

Yes - Dr. Rai spent the first few minutes reviewing torque vs. force with the appropriate units

Are objectives used to identify the intent of the day's activities?

yes - written on the board and referred to often

Does the lesson include a review of previous course materials?

yes - started with a practice and review of the previous chapter**Classroom Management**

Does the instructor appear prepared and organized?

yes - very well organized. power point was well laid out

How does the student/teacher relationship appear?

Good- the interactivity and engagement of the students was jovial and on task

Do students appear comfortable asking questions?

yes- points of clarification were interjected by the students.

Are there any distractions and if so, how are disruptive students handled?

none-

How are late-arriving students handled?

allowed to enter quietly without attention.

Class Session

Are the class session objectives clearly identified?

yes - written on the board

What types of instructional strategies are used?

Visual, auditory and participatory strategies were used to engage students

Does the lesson seem logically sequenced?

yes the lesson built on the previous one

Does the instructor refer to objectives periodically during the lesson?

yes- the formula for pressure was written on the board and referred to throughout the lesson

How does the instructor attempt to involve students in the class? Are students actively involved in the class session?

Yes - Dr. Rai used a demonstration of Bernoulli's Principle with a student a sheet of paper. Students were asked to interact by blowing the paper and then asked to explain what happened.

How does the instructor respond to correct and incorrect student responses?

Correct responses were encouraged - incorrect responses were asked to think about the answer some more.

Does the instructor demonstrate a positive role model for the students?

yes!- very enthusiastic. There were multiple graphics to work from and problems to solve which reinforced the lesson.

Are multiple learning styles addressed during this session?

Auditory, visual, and participatory

What type(s) of instructional media are used during the class session?

power point; You Tube; and text book examples

Does the instructor refer to outside references such as text, web sites, or articles?

Yes - textbook examples

Summary:

What are the greatest strengths demonstrated during today's class session?

Knowledge and the willingness to work with students on problems. Dr. Rai was helpful working with students without giving them the answers. They had to come to the correct solution using their own deductive powers.

What might be done to improve this class session?

Circulate through the entire room. Students on the side of the room closest to the windows were not given the opportunity for individual attention by the instructor. This may have been a function of where the observation was being made.

Rating:

☐ Unprofessional Performance
☒ Professional Level

☐ Improvement Required
☐ Exemplary Performance

Observation Conducted by:

Deborah Gates

10/31/12

Date